

The Daily Brief

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Markets & Finance

What moved money this week

SpaceX's \$75 Billion IPO Just Rewrote the Record Books — Twice. When SpaceX debuted on Friday, it wasn't just another tech listing. The company raised \$75 billion in the largest initial public offering in Wall Street history, ended its first day up 19%, and closed with a market capitalization around \$2.2 trillion. That single day turned Elon Musk into the world's first trillionaire — a word that now has a real meaning. The IPO was so large it overwhelmed Robinhood's systems, causing intermittent outages as retail traders piled in. The New York City Comptroller immediately raised concerns about fast-tracking SpaceX's inclusion into MSCI and FTSE Russell indexes, bypassing traditional seasoning requirements, and flagged the company's governance structure — where one person holds near-absolute control with limited shareholder rights — as unprecedented for a public company of this size. (TechCrunch, Bloomberg)

The MANGOS IPO Window Is Wide Open. SpaceX is not alone. The IPO market is experiencing its most consequential moment in years, with what analysts are calling the "MANGOS" cohort — Meta, Anthropic, Nvidia, Google, OpenAI, and SpaceX — all circling public markets in the same window. Anthropic filed to go public shortly after the government ordered its most powerful AI model taken offline over safety concerns, a move Anthropic publicly protested, calling the narrow jailbreak finding insufficient justification for recalling a model used by hundreds of millions of people. Meanwhile, French AI startup Mistral is reportedly raising €3 billion at a €20 billion valuation, nearly doubling its previous valuation from just months ago. The concentration of AI royalty in public markets is unprecedented — and it's a stress test for every valuation framework Wall Street has. (TechCrunch, Bloomberg)

Gold Miners Are Moving Like Meme Stocks — And That's a Red Flag. Gold prices have been on a historic run, driven by geopolitical uncertainty and central bank buying. But something unusual is happening at the mining level: gold producers are trading with the volatility of meme stocks rather than the staid, slow-moving assets investors typically expect. The miners aren't just reflecting gold prices — they're amplifying them, moving faster and farther than the underlying commodity. For investors who thought buying gold miners was a "safe hedge," this behavior is a warning that correlations can break down in ways that hurt even in the assets you own for protection. (Bloomberg)

US-Iran Talks on Hormuz Are Closer Than They Look. Pakistan said an interim US-Iran deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz could be finalized within 24 hours. The strait handles roughly 20% of the world's oil shipments, and any resolution would ease a critical chokepoint that's kept energy traders nervous for months. If a deal holds, it removes a meaningful risk premium from oil prices — which would be welcome relief for an economy still adjusting to elevated energy costs. (Bloomberg)

Tech & AI

The machines keep learning — and fighting back

The Government Pulled the Plug on Anthropic's Best AI. Anthropic Is Furious. In a move that has rattled the AI industry, US regulators ordered Anthropic to take its most powerful model offline following safety tests that identified a potential "jailbreak" vulnerability — a way for sophisticated users to circumvent the model's safety guardrails. Anthropic pushed back hard in a blog post, saying it "disagrees that the finding of a narrow potential jailbreak should be cause for recalling a commercial model deployed to hundreds of millions of people." The irony is sharp: Anthropic built its brand on safety-first AI development, and now those safety warnings are being used against its flagship product. The incident raises serious questions about who has the authority to yank AI models from public circulation — and whether safety-conscious companies are being held to a higher standard than their less-cautious competitors. (TechCrunch)

Inside Meta's AI Factory: 6,500 Engineers, Growing Unrest. A disturbing report emerged this week describing Meta's AI division as a "soul-crushing gulag," in the words of engineers stuck inside it. The unit employs 6,500 people and is reportedly on the verge of revolt — citing brutal hours, unclear direction, and a culture of internal competition that has little to do with the open-source ideals Meta preaches externally. The report is a reminder that the AI race isn't just about compute and data — it's about talent retention, and the companies burning through their workforce with impossible expectations may find their models suffering right when they need them most. (TechCrunch)

Google Sues Chinese Cybercrime Ring Using AI to Scam Hundreds of Thousands. Google filed a lawsuit against a group called "Outsider Enterprise" that allegedly used AI to generate and send 2.5 million text messages over two weeks, scamming hundreds of thousands of victims. The case illustrates the dual-use nature of AI: the same language models that power legitimate chatbots are being weaponized by fraud operations at a scale that was impossible just a few years ago. It's also a reminder that AI safety isn't only about existential risk — it's about the mundane, everyday fraud that AI makes dramatically cheaper to execute. (TechCrunch)

Mistral's Meteoric Rise — And What Comes Next. French AI startup Mistral is reportedly in talks to raise €3 billion at a €20 billion valuation, nearly double its Series C from months ago. The company has been one of Europe's few genuine challengers to US AI dominance, and the fundraise — if completed — would make it one of the most valuable private AI companies in the world. The question is whether European AI can sustain this momentum, or whether the compute and data advantages of US hyperscalers will prove insurmountable. (TechCrunch)

Google Search Is Getting a Full AI Overhaul. In one of the biggest changes to the world's most-visited website, Google is rolling out a comprehensive AI-powered redesign of Search. The changes embed AI-generated answers more deeply into search results, moving Google further from its original mission of pointing users to links and toward a model where Google answers questions directly. The World Cup — currently co-hosted by the US, Canada, and Mexico — is also providing a backdrop for Google to show off its AI-enhanced coverage tools. (Bloomberg)

Briefly

- World Cup 2026 is underway across the US, Canada, and Mexico, with opening matches drawing massive global audiences and providing a platform for tech companies — including Google — to showcase AI-powered sports coverage.
 - Switzerland is voting on a population ceiling that would cap the country at 10 million residents, a proposal with significant implications for immigration policy and the country's role as a global financial center.
 - China rebukes US over "military company" labels for its top firms, accusing Washington of using national security as a pretext to curb Chinese technology development.
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The Takeaway

The SpaceX IPO didn't just make Elon Musk a trillionaire — it announced that the AI investment thesis has officially migrated from private markets to public ones. For the first time, retail investors can buy a piece of the AI royalty through their brokerage accounts, and the MANGOS IPO wave suggests this is just the beginning. But the Anthropic episode is the counterweight: the government's willingness to pull a commercial AI model offline shows that regulatory risk is real, not theoretical. The companies building the most powerful AI are discovering that their safety credentials are a double-edged sword — the same regulators who scrutinize them most closely are the ones who can shut them down fastest. The trade is compelling, but the oversight is real.